



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: When it's time to say you're sorry.



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can write a short personal note.
- I can write about people's personality.
- I can make promises.

Ask your partner:

- Do you find it hard to apologize?
- Do you say sorry in person, online, or by telephone?
- How do you usually apologize? Do you do anything special?





Let's Explore!

Marco is writing Vanessa an apology letter.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Dear Vanessa,

I wanted to write to you to apologize for my obnoxious and insensitive behavior.

The way I acted on our date last night was completely inappropriate. I am ashamed to say that I embarrassed you in public.

Come to think of it, making fun of you about the "Picasso" painting and scaring you with the geese were not some of my finer moments either. This is an especially terrible thing for me to do since I know you are terrified of birds. I know that I have hurt you and you deserve better.

You are such an incredible person, I don't want to lose what we have. I hope you can forgive my immaturity so that we can move forward in our relationship. I'm actually a decent guy. I will be on my best behavior when we see your friends next week. I promise to make it up to you.

Marco





Let's Practice!

What is included in an apology letter? Let's find out!

Instructions: Choose the correct answer.

1. Which sentence would you use to start an apology letter?

- ☐ This is an especially terrible thing for me to do since I know you are terrified of birds.
- ☐ I wanted to write to you to apologize for my obnoxious and insensitive behavior.
- ☐ Come to think of it, making fun of you about the "Picasso" painting and scaring you with the geese were not some of my finer moments either.

2. Which sentence can you use to conclude an apology letter?

- ☐ I promise to make it up to you.
- ☐ The way I acted on our date last night was completely inappropriate. I am ashamed to say that I embarrassed you in public.
- ☐ Dear Vanessa,

3. Which sentence describes Marco's personality?

- ☐ I know that I have hurt you and you deserve better.
- ☐ I'm actually a decent guy.
- ☐ The way I acted on our date last night was completely inappropriate.



Let's Practice!

What does Marco promise? Do you believe him?

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Write each word in the correct order.

I / you. / friends / to / your / up / see / it / we / make / when / to / behavior /
promise / best / week. / my / next / on / be / will / I



Extension Activity

Relationships can be hard work! Write an apology letter to someone after a bad breakup.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write an apology letter.
- Include a greeting and a closing.
- Write a statement about why you are writing a letter.
- Include the mistakes made.
- Acknowledge that you hurt others.
- Express gratitude.
- Accept responsibility for your actions.
- Make a promise.
- Read your letter aloud to a partner or family member.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I write an apology letter to someone I care about.

☐ ☐

I use a greeting and closing in a letter.

☐ ☐

I write a structured letter to express my feelings.

☐ ☐

I proofread my work.

☐ ☐

I read my apology letter aloud.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- insensitive** (adjective): showing that you do not know or care about the feelings of other people
e.g. I apologize for my insensitive behavior.
- immaturity** (noun): acting in a childish way
e.g. I showed a lot of immaturity.
- finer** (adjective): good, acceptable, or satisfactory
e.g. It was not one of my finer moments.
- ashamed** (adjective): feeling shame or guilt
e.g. You were so ashamed of me.
- come to think of it** (expression): when I think back
e.g. Come to think of it, I embarrassed you last week too.
- decent** (adjective): polite, moral, and honest
e.g. I'm actually a pretty decent guy.
- gratitude** (noun): feeling of appreciation or thanks
e.g. I wanted to express my gratitude.





Learning Points

An Apology Letter

When you write an apology letter, you need to:

1. State why you are writing the letter.

Example: I am writing you this letter to apologize.

2. Admit your mistake or inappropriate behavior.

Say what you're apologizing for and why it was wrong. You need to be very specific and clear.

Example: I am sorry for yelling at you.

3. Write about how much you hurt the other person.

Acknowledge that the person was hurt and that you understand how they may feel.

Example: I embarrassed you in public and that is unforgivable.

4. Express your gratitude.

Show that you really do feel badly about what you did and that you value this person.

Example: You are an incredible person.

5. Accept responsibility.

You need to admit that your mistake is your responsibility.

Example: What I did at the restaurant was wrong.

6. State how you will make this a better relationship in the future.

Express that you would like to move forward and learn from past errors.

Example: I hope we can move forward from this and look towards the future.





Learning Points

Making and Responding To Promises

You use the Future tense to make promises.

Often the moment the event will happen is unknown.

This tense is often used with the following time expressions:

soon, next month, next week

Positive

Subject + will + verb + object(s) + time expression

Example: I will be on my best behavior when we see your friends next week.

